

MUSIC REVIEW

A Classic MOVE

At a time when Indo-Pak relations are seeing a downturn, Pakistan-based singer Shafqat Amanat Ali Khan through his latest album, *Kyun Dooriyaan*, tries to bring in some hope. "My songs are for every relationship. I feel that it is a message for the Indo-Pak relationship right now," says the singer of the fame *Tere naina* from *My Name is Khan*. Also known as the Rockstar Ustad, a term coined by music director Salim Merchant, his songs are well thought out. What is truly wonderful about his compositions

is the dextrous use of both classical and western instruments. His interludes and introductions to the song are seductive. Khan uses Indian instruments like the sarod, flute and sarangi in a contemporary way. Some tracks like *Kya haal sunawan*, *Mahiya*, *Tu hi sanam* and *Kartar* are worth listening to. He has also adapted old traditional compositions and given them new energy with his own interpretation and style. In the traditional composition *Pahari*, he gives a new flavour. "If it weren't for classical music, I wouldn't have been singing at all," says Khan. Don't miss these songs of love and friendship.

by S. Sahaya Ranjit

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ART EXHIBITION

Painting WIZARD

Paresh Maity, the master of light, has a big show opening in Delhi on March 13. The World on a Canvas is a visual travelogue of Maity's works and features works by him since 1983. While the artist is well-known and has often enough been exalted as the wizard of watercolours, this show includes drawings, oils, mixed media, sculptures and a large installation. Two short films by the Maity, *The Mystic Melody—A Day in the Golden Desert* and *The Magic of Monsoons—Montage, Moments, Memories*, are also part of the offering. If travelling is an integral part of Maity's life, his travels are the life of his art.

A WORK ON DISPLAY



Kerala, Rajasthan, Bengal, China, Egypt and Mexico, the artist has recorded his impressions of them all. It is this visual dairy that goes on display this month, along with a book by actor Sharmila Tagore. The book charts Maity's journey from the dinky West Bengal town of Tamluk, where he first realised his calling as an artist, to Venice, which thrilled the colour-junkie in him. Drawing from memory, experiences and anecdotes gathered from her exchanges with the artist, Tagore presents a new side to him.

Her words are accompanied by portraits of Maity at work by photographer Nemai Ghosh. The show opens at the Lalit Kala Akademi, Delhi. It will remain on display there for two weeks after which it will move to Art Alive Gallery, Delhi. On till April 10.

by Shampa Kamath

